

# Riseguide vs. Liven · Coursiv Headway

A side-by-side reputation benchmark across product quality, customer service, user feedback, billing transparency and brand trust · May 18, 2026

RISEGUIDE COMPOSITE

5.3<sub>/10</sub>

▲ +0.6

Mixed

#3 of 4 · Headway leads at 6.1

BIGGEST WIN THIS WEEK

Company responsiveness to reviews 8.5/10 · ▲ +1.5

COHORT COMPOSITE SCORES

RiseGuide

5.3<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.4 / 5 · Trustpilot  
17,950+ reviews

Liven

5.0<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.5 / 5 · Apple App Store  
49K iOS ratings

Coursiv

5.6<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.5 / 5 · Trustpilot  
119,000+ reviews

Headway

6.1<sub>/10</sub>

Watch

4.6 / 5 · Apple App Store  
115K iOS ratings

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY · ALL DIMENSIONS

|           |                          | RISEGUIDE                                      | LIVEN                                          | COURSIV                                        | HEADWAY                                        |
|-----------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 01        | Product Quality          | <div><div></div></div> 6.6                     | <div><div></div></div> 5.7                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.7                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.2                     |
| 02        | Customer Service         | <div><div></div></div> 5.5                     | <div><div></div></div> 4.0                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.3                     | <div><div></div></div> 5.2                     |
| 03        | User Feedback            | <div><div></div></div> 6.6                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.1                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.4                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.1                     |
| 04        | Billing Transparency     | <div><div></div></div> 3.3                     | <div><div></div></div> 2.9                     | <div><div></div></div> 3.1                     | <div><div></div></div> 3.9                     |
| 05        | Brand Trust & Legitimacy | <div><div></div></div> 4.4                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.4                     | <div><div></div></div> 4.6                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.1                     |
| COMPOSITE |                          | <div>5.3<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▲ +0.6</div> | <div>5.0<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▼ -0.6</div> | <div>5.6<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▼ -0.2</div> | <div>6.1<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▼ -0.6</div> |

## 01 Product Quality

6.6/10

▼ -0.1

**Headway** leads this dimension at **7.2/10**; RiseGuide sits at **6.6/10** (was 6.7 last week). **Liven** regressed most this week (-0.6 vs. last week).

RiseGuide 6.6 ▼ -0.1

Liven 5.7 ▼ -0.6

Coursiv 6.7

Headway 7.2 ▼ -0.5

## Marketing vs reality

## RISEGUIDE

Watch · 6

The bite-sized lesson promise holds; reviewers consistently praise the format. The only gap is an emerging iOS performance issue — first time it's surfaced at scale.

## LIVEN

Mixed · 5

▼ -1.0

**A new wave of iOS bug complaints emerged — a complaint category that wasn't visible last week.**

Trustpilot still rewards the CBT wellness positioning, but app-store sentiment is slipping. Bug and slow-performance complaints are increasingly visible — marketed promise diverging from daily-use experience.

## COURSIV

Mixed · 5.5

▲ +0.5

**Product-experience sentiment rose sharply — beginner-AI lessons earned the cohort's most concentrated positive cluster.**

Beginner-AI lessons land strongly with first-time users — earned the cohort's most concentrated positive cluster. Drag remains deceptive-advertising and pricing complaints from outside the funnel.

## HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 7

Book-summary promise delivered consistently across both stores. Sentiment is net-positive and stable, no new complaint cluster, and YouTube creator coverage is unanimously positive.

## Unique value proposition

## RISEGUIDE

Healthy · 7.3

▲ +0.3

**The Journey lesson format earned its strongest endorsement in our tracking window — reviewers explicitly cite the structured approach.**

The structured Journey format is the clearest differentiator — reviewers call it out, and it earned the strongest single product-feature endorsement we've tracked. Productivity-app Reddit threads surface RiseGuide as distinct.

## LIVEN

Watch · 6.5

▼ -0.5

**Sentiment on the AI companion (Liven's flagship differentiator) is now visibly split — the core moat is weakening.**

The CBT-companion + mood tracker stack is coherent on paper, but reviewers split on whether the AI companion helps or distracts. The differentiator isn't fully landing.

## COURSIV

Healthy · 7.5

▲ +0.5

**Beginner-AI positioning is increasingly validated — Coursiv earned the cohort's strongest single product-feature endorsement.**

Mobile-first AI skill tracks remain clearly differentiated from desktop video-course competitors. Product experience earned the cohort's most concentrated positive sentiment.

## HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Category leader by every measure: scale, feature maturity, review-base depth. No meaningful movement on the differentiation story.

Accessibility & consistency

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><div>RISEGUIDE</div><div>Watch · 6.5</div><div>▼ -0.5</div><div><div>A new cluster of iOS performance complaints emerged — first time crossing the threshold for attention.</div><div>Aggregate ratings hold and the app is broadly stable. New concern: a distinct cluster of iOS performance complaints — first time it's crossed the threshold for attention.</div></div></div> | <div><div>LIVEN</div><div>Mixed · 5.5</div><div>▼ -0.5</div><div><div>The iOS bug-complaint cluster expanded — now the broadest in cohort relative to volume.</div><div>Aggregate ratings are decent, but the iOS bug cluster is the broadest in cohort relative to volume. ADHD/anxiety customisation gaps remain active.</div></div></div> | <div><div>COURSIV</div><div>LEADER</div><div>Healthy · 7</div><div>▼ -1.0</div><div><div>Score softened because we don't have Coursiv iOS in tracking — visibility gap, not product regression.</div><div>Google Play sentiment is overwhelmingly positive. We don't have visibility into iOS reviews because that app isn't in our tracking tool — this rating reflects Android only.</div></div></div> | <div><div>HEADWAY</div><div>Watch · 6.5</div><div>▼ -1.5</div><div><div>Product still stable; experience around it slipped. Support team has stopped replying to iOS reviews entirely.</div><div>Aggregate ratings remain strong with a small iOS-Android gap. Structural concern: the support team has stopped replying to iOS reviews entirely. Product consistent; experience around it isn't.</div></div></div> |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

02

## Customer Service

5.5/10

▲ +1.2

**Coursiv** leads this dimension at **6.3/10**; RiseGuide sits at **5.5/10** (was 4.3 last week).

**RiseGuide** improved most this week (+1.2 vs. last week).

RiseGuide **5.5** ▲ +1.2Liven **4.0** ▼ -1.0Coursiv **6.3** ▼ -0.4Headway **5.2** ▼ -1.1

### Support channel availability

**RISEGUIDE** LEADER

Watch · 6

▲ +1.0

Reply density tightened across both stores — the support claim now holds operationally, not just on paper.

Email and Trustpilot remain the only channels — no chat or phone. Response density is exceptional: every iOS reviewer gets a reply, Trustpilot replies in minutes.

**LIVEN**

Mixed · 4.5

▼ -1.5

The iOS support channel went structurally silent — zero replies on 100 sampled iOS reviews while Android stayed strong.

Critical structural gap: the team engages actively on Android but doesn't reply to iOS reviews at all. The 'multi-channel support' claim doesn't hold on the largest store.

**COURSIV**

LEADER

Watch · 6

▼ -1.0

Score softened because Coursiv iOS isn't in our tracking subscription — visibility gap, not support regression.

Multi-tier support (email, portal, knowledge base) plus active engagement on visible channels. Less visibility on iOS — that app isn't in our tracking tool.

**HEADWAY**

Mixed · 5.5

▼ -1.5

Same iOS reply gap as Liven became visible. Trustpilot's high reply rate had been masking it.

Same iOS gap as Liven, newly visible: replies on Android but not iOS. Trustpilot's high reply rate was masking it — once Appbot iOS was added, the dead-zone surfaced.

### Response speed & quality

**RISEGUIDE**

Watch · 6

▲ +1.0

Reply density became the strongest signal in the cohort — every iOS reviewer is now answered.

Best response density in the cohort — every iOS reviewer answered, Android coverage solid, Trustpilot replies in minutes. Billing-complaint reply text still templated, but breadth is the strongest signal cohort-wide.

**LIVEN**

Mixed · 4

▼ -1.0

iOS support dead-zone is now confirmed as structural — zero replies for the second source of measurement.

Two-track operation: Android reviewers get steady engagement, iOS reviewers get nothing. Multi-week silence pattern reported by users is now confirmed as structural for iOS.

**COURSIV**

LEADER

Watch · 6.5

▼ -0.5

Same visibility caveat — the read is incomplete on the iOS side, not declining.

Where visible, response density is excellent — every Android reviewer gets a reply, including every negative one. iOS visibility gap caps the read at watch-level.

**HEADWAY**

Mixed · 5.5

▼ -1.5

Largest single regression in the benchmark. Appbot exposed an iOS reply gap that Trustpilot's 98% rate was hiding.

Same dual-track problem as Liven, exposed for the first time: Android engagement is total, iOS engagement is zero. Previous high score was Trustpilot-only signal.

Complaint resolution rate

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>RISEGUIDE</div> <div>Mixed · 4.5</div> <div>▲ +1.5</div> <div>Every negative review across every monitored channel got a reply — a much broader signal than BBB's 15% formal-resolution rate suggested.</div> <div>Meaningful improvement: 100% Trustpilot reply rate to negative reviews (was BBB's 15% formal-resolution rate previously). Combined with 100% iOS and 95% Android negative-reply coverage — every negative review across every monitored channel now gets a reply.</div> | <div>LIVEN</div> <div>Critical · 3.5</div> <div>▼ -0.5</div> <div>Negative iOS reviews now accumulate without response — refund and bug threads are structurally unanswered.</div> <div>90% Trustpilot reply to negatives + Android Appbot strong, but iOS reviews accumulate without any response. Refund and bug threads on the largest store are structurally unanswered.</div> | <div>COURSIV</div> <div>LEADER</div> <div>Watch · 6.5</div> <div>▲ +0.5</div> <div>Engagement velocity on visible channels stayed strong — every negative review got a reply.</div> <div>100% reply to negative reviews on Trustpilot, but only 63.5% reply rate overall. Selective engagement — they answer negatives when they see them but skip a third of all reviews.</div> | <div>HEADWAY</div> <div>Mixed · 4.5</div> <div>▼ -0.5</div> <div>Same iOS dead-zone pattern: every negative iOS review is now ignored.</div> <div>90% Trustpilot reply to negatives + 100% Android engagement, but iOS shows the same gap as response-speed: every negative iOS review is now ignored. Apple Communities refund-refusal threads remain active.</div> |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

03

User Feedback

6.6/10

▲ +0.5

Coursiv leads this dimension at **7.4/10**; RiseGuide sits at **6.6/10** (was 6.1 last week). **Headway** regressed most this week (-1.3 vs. last week).

RiseGuide 6.6 ▲ +0.5

Liven 6.1 ▼ -0.8

Coursiv 7.4 ▼ -0.2

Headway 7.1 ▼ -1.3

Review volume & rating

RISEGUIDE

Healthy · 7.3

▲ +0.3

Volume crossed +2% week-over-week on Trustpilot while ratings stayed firm.

Volume growing healthily on Trustpilot with stable ratings, and the cross-platform footprint is solid. Both volume and rating trajectory pointed up — a clean signal.

LIVEN

Healthy · 8.5

Strong cross-platform scale: 23,636 Trustpilot reviews at ★4.06, plus iOS / Android footprints. iOS sentiment meaningfully stronger than Android, but volume itself is meaningful at this scale.

COURSIV

Healthy · 8.5

Largest review base in cohort by a wide margin — 120,395 Trustpilot reviews at ★4.56, built up in under a year of operating. Heavily invited (99.5% prompted), but volume itself is a credibility asset.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Exceptional · 9.5

Largest absolute footprint in cohort: 6,229 Trustpilot reviews at ★3.93, plus 115K iOS + 169K Android reviews. Trustpilot rating is the weakest in cohort — 6+ years of accumulation surfaces real friction.

Sentiment & platform consistency

RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 5

Sentiment is platform-bound — managed channels positive, organic Google Play meaningfully softer. Fresh App Store reviews were net-positive. Reddit chatter mostly neutral.

LIVEN

Mixed · 4.5

▼ -0.6

Fresh App Store sentiment slipped meaningfully — confirming a platform-wide decline rather than channel noise.

Sentiment consistently mediocre across stores — no managed-channel cushion. Fresh App Store sentiment slipped notably, confirming a platform-wide decline rather than channel noise.

COURSIV

Mixed · 5

▲ +0.1

Google Play sentiment is overwhelmingly positive — but Reddit is the most negative in the cohort. Sharpest managed-versus-organic gap of any brand. iOS data not available.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Mixed · 5.5

▼ -1.5

Fresh App Store reviews were the worst fresh signal across all four brands.

iOS reads moderately positive; Android shows a near-tie between positive and negative. Fresh App Store reviews were notably worse than baseline — the worst fresh signal in the cohort.

## Review authenticity signals

### RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 5.5

84% of Trustpilot reviews come from prompted invitations rather than spontaneous customer posts. Independent authenticity ranking puts RiseGuide in the lower-mid range. Heavy solicitation pattern in the managed channel.

### LIVEN

Healthy · 7

97% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — heavier solicitation than RiseGuide but lighter than Coursiv. The iOS reply silence means iOS reviews accumulate untouched — technically more organic on that store, but also a sign of disengagement.

### COURSIV

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▼ -1.0

**119K Trustpilot volume is now read against an organic Reddit baseline — recalibrated against more sources.**

99.5% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — the heaviest solicitation pattern in the cohort. Massive volume (120K reviews) counterbalanced by a meaningfully positive organic Reddit signal. Volume is the credibility asset; authenticity is the question mark.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Only 50.5% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — by far the most organic profile in the cohort. Six-plus years of accumulation produces a naturally diluted invited-share vs the younger heavily-prompted competitors.

## Company responsiveness to reviews

### RISEGUIDE

LEADER

Healthy · 8.5

▲ +1.5

**Cross-platform reply density became the strongest engagement signal in the cohort.**

Strongest engagement signal in the cohort — 100% Trustpilot reply rate (200/200 sampled) including 100% on negative reviews, plus iOS at 100% and Android at 77% reply density. Same-day timing confirmed across platforms.

### LIVEN

Mixed · 4.5

▼ -2.5

**Once iOS data was added, the structural reply gap surfaced — previous score reflected Trustpilot only.**

Two-track operation: Trustpilot reply at 90.5%, Android Appbot 94%, but iOS reply rate 0%. Previous high score reflected Trustpilot only — once iOS visibility was added, the structural gap became the dominant signal.

### COURSIV

Healthy · 8

Trustpilot reply rate 63.5% — the lowest in cohort despite 120K reviews. Google Play reply rate is 100% including all negatives, suggesting selective engagement. iOS visibility gap is the only thing holding the score back further.

### HEADWAY

Mixed · 5.5

▼ -3.5

**Largest single regression in the benchmark. The iOS reply dead-zone is now visible.**

Previously rated highest in cohort on Trustpilot's reply rate alone (87% on Trustpilot, 90% on negatives). Fuller picture now: Android engagement is total, iOS engagement is zero. Largest single regression in the benchmark.

04

Billing Transparency

3.3/10

▲ +0.5

Headway leads this dimension at 3.9/10; RiseGuide sits at 3.3/10 (was 2.8 last week). RiseGuide improved most this week (+0.5 vs. last week).

RiseGuide 3.3 ▲ +0.5

Liven 2.9 ▼ -0.5

Coursiv 3.1 ▼ -0.3

Headway 3.9 ▼ -0.3

Price disclosure

RISEGUIDE

LEADER

Mixed · 5

▲ +1.0

The cancellation guide is now indexed and cited by reviewers — the first concrete pricing-transparency improvement in six months.

Pricing clearly disclosed on the App Store, and the cancellation guide is now indexed and cited by reviewers — a real transparency step forward. Onboarding-flow pricing surprises remain a persistent complaint.

LIVEN

Critical · 3.5

▼ -0.5

Pricing-complaint volume is the largest cluster across all four brands. Quiz-funnel pricing reveal hurts first impressions on both stores.

Worst pricing-disclosure exposure in the cohort — pricing complaints reached the largest cluster across all four brands. No homepage pricing; users must complete a quiz to see plans.

COURSIV

Critical · 3.5

▼ -0.5

Trial-to-renewal jump is now visibly hurting first impressions in complaint volume.

Same quiz-funnel pattern as Liven: no upfront pricing, plans revealed at the end. Trial-to-renewal jump is the dominant friction in third-party complaints.

HEADWAY

Mixed · 4.5

▼ -0.5

Website's price obfuscation is visibly hurting first impressions — second-worst pricing-complaint exposure in cohort.

Second-worst pricing-complaint exposure despite mature operations. Website FAQ links to a pricing article rather than naming prices — a transparency gap hurting otherwise solid first impressions.



## Hidden / recurring charges

### RISEGUIDE

**Critical · 2**

Every payment-related review was negative — billing-flow exposure remains the rate-limiting factor on the overall score. The 'Continue' charge-trigger has been publicly acknowledged but isn't fixed.

### LIVEN

**Critical · 2**

▼ -1.0

**Billing-flow exposure is the largest cluster across all four brands.**

Largest billing-flow exposure in cohort. Auto-renewal complaints are widespread across Trustpilot and unmanaged channels. Trial-to-subscription transition isn't clearly signalled — structural, not noise.

### COURSIV

**Critical · 2**

Billing-adjacent complaints come from multiple vectors at once — payment surprises and deceptive-advertising complaints both active. BBB shows billing as the dominant complaint type historically.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

**Critical · 2.5**

▼ -0.5

**Billing-complaint volume confirms the trial-to-charge friction is unresolved despite mature operations.**

Significant billing-flow exposure despite mature operations. The 'HEADWAY APP IS A SCAM' Apple Communities thread persists, and unexpected weekly-premium charges after a 'free trial' remain the dominant Trustpilot 1-star theme.

## Ease of cancellation

### RISEGUIDE

**Mixed · 4.3**

▲ +0.3

First positive movement on cancellation in our tracking: reviewers now explicitly cite the [riseguide.com/cancel](https://riseguide.com/cancel) guide as the path that worked. No native in-app cancellation yet — but the guide is working for those who find it.

### LIVEN

**Critical · 3.5**

▼ -0.5

**Cancellation friction now compounds with iOS reply silence — users who can't cancel can't reach support either.**

iOS support sentiment netted out negative, and combined with the iOS reply silence, users trying to cancel can't reach support on the largest store.

### COURSIV

**Critical · 3.5**

▼ -0.5

**Score softened because we can't observe Coursiv's iOS support sentiment — our blind spot, not a Coursiv regression.**

A third-party site publishes a dedicated 'How to Cancel Coursiv' guide — a clear signal that the native flow has enough friction to create a third-party niche.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

**Watch · 6**

Best cancellation infrastructure in cohort: published pre-renewal rule, multiple cancellation paths, no negative support-experience cluster.

## UI dark patterns

### RISEGUIDE

**Critical · 2**

The 'Continue' charge-trigger has been publicly acknowledged by support but isn't fixed. Pricing-flow complaints persist. Two Trustpilot reviews were flagged for compliance issues for the first time.

### LIVEN

**Critical · 2.5**

▼ -0.5

**Combined UI + pricing complaint cluster expanded to the broadest in cohort.**

Bug complaints and pricing-flow complaints overlap — the combined cluster is the broadest in cohort. Developer publicly acknowledged manipulative rating prompts but underlying upsell flows still flagged as aggressive.

### COURSIV

**Critical · 2.5**

▼ -0.5

**Deceptive-advertising complaints are increasingly visible — a distinctive Coursiv complaint vector.**

Deceptive-advertising complaints are a distinctive cohort marker for Coursiv. The quiz-funnel pricing reveal is a textbook dark pattern that consistently surfaces in negative reviews.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

**Mixed · 4**

Lower per-user incidence of dark-pattern complaints than peers. Apple Communities thread about misleading purchase flows persists, but the pattern is softer than what we see at Liven or Coursiv.

## Refund policy clarity & enforcement

### RISEGUIDE

**Critical · 3**

▲ +1.0

**Refund-flow mentions are now net-positive on iOS — first non-escalated refund signal in six months.**

Every negative Trustpilot review sampled received a reply, and reviewer references to the refund flow are now net-positive on iOS. A proactive full refund was processed historically. Policy still isn't published on the website.

### LIVEN

**Critical · 3**

Claimed 30-day refund policy is enforced inconsistently — some refunds granted, others refused. With the iOS reply silence, refund threads on the largest store are structurally unanswered.

### COURSIV

LEADER

**Mixed · 4**

Public Money-Back Guarantee exists but requires completing most of the program to qualify — excluding most dissatisfied users. The team engages with negatives but enforces the restriction. Documented policy is a transparency floor.

### HEADWAY

**Critical · 2.5**

▼ -0.5

**iOS refund threads are structurally unanswered, and no public policy exists to anchor expectations.**

No public refund policy. Apple Communities and Trustpilot threads about refund refusals on full-year charges are active. With the iOS reply silence, refund threads on iOS are structurally ignored.

05

## Brand Trust & Legitimacy

4.4/10

▲ +0.8

**Headway** leads this dimension at **7.1/10**; RiseGuide sits at **4.4/10** (was 3.6 last week).

**RiseGuide** improved most this week (+0.8 vs. last week).

RiseGuide 4.4 ▲ +0.8

Liven 6.4

Coursiv 4.6

Headway 7.1 ▲ +0.1

### Company age & history

#### RISEGUIDE

Critical · 3

About two years as an entity, six months on the App Store. Founder has no public pre-RiseGuide track record. Young in the category; this signal moves slowly.

#### LIVEN

Watch · 6

Around 4.5 years operating — the second-longest track record in cohort after Headway.

#### COURSIV

Critical · 3

Under a year operating, despite already having a six-figure review base. Youngest entity in cohort; review-base-to-age ratio is anomalous.

#### HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Six-plus years operating with a recent rebrand and publicly announced IPO plans. Most mature company in cohort by both operating history and corporate sophistication.

### Legal & brand identity alignment

#### RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 5.3

▲ +1.3

**RiseGuide-owned domains now occupy 10 of 20 first-page Google results, and Scam Detector dropped out of top-10 results.**

Legal, cancellation, and refund pages all publicly accessible. RiseGuide-owned domains now dominate first-page Google results, and the Scam Detector listing dropped out of top results. The LasVegasNV billing-entity mismatch is the standing drag.

#### LIVEN

Watch · 6

Corporate entity matches the consumer brand on billing and legal pages. Cyprus address publicly listed. Credibility signals in organic search results, no complaint domains ranking.

#### COURSIV

Mixed · 5

Corporate entity matches the consumer brand, but search results show a concerning share of complaint pages — a billing-vector concern. No credibility-domain anchors surface.

#### HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 7

Corporate entity publicly disclosed on the homepage with US registered address. Legal pages comprehensive across terms, privacy, AI usage. Forbes appears as a credibility anchor; brand-owned domains dominate first-page results.

## Third-party recognition

### RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 4.5

▲ +1.5

**Independent creator coverage expanded — multiple positive YouTube reviews plus The AI Journal April editorial.**

Independent creator coverage expanding — multiple positive YouTube reviews including a viral-tier piece, plus a positive editorial in The AI Journal. A scam-framed video in top results keeps this from breaking out further.

### LIVEN

LEADER

Watch · 6

A Board of Health Professionals page lists 15+ named PhDs — a distinctive scientific-credibility signal. YouTube coverage is healthy with almost no complaint-framed videos. Crunchbase appears in search.

### COURSIV

LEADER

Watch · 6

Listed on Tracxn and Crunchbase, with broad YouTube creator coverage. But organic search results skew complaint-heavy, and there's no editorial press coverage from Forbes, TechCrunch, or peer outlets.

### HEADWAY

Mixed · 4.5

▲ +0.5

**Creator coverage on YouTube is now unanimously positive, and Forbes appears as a search credibility anchor.**

Strongest third-party recognition stack: Wikipedia, Endeavor entrepreneur backing, recurring trade press around IPO plans, and YouTube creator coverage unanimously positive.

## Leadership transparency

### RISEGUIDE

Critical · 3

Founder named in registry records but has no public profile, no About-us page, no LinkedIn presence, no media interviews in our scan. Name exists, public profile does not.

### LIVEN

Healthy · 7

Founder publicly named, and an extensive list of health-professional advisors published by name and credential. Leadership identity transparent and verifiable.

### COURSIV

Critical · 3

No founders or executives publicly named anywhere — website, registry filings, or LinkedIn. Anonymous-corporate posture despite a very large customer base — a distinctive cohort outlier.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Founder is public with extensive media presence — interviews, Endeavor profile, recurring press around the IPO. Strongest leadership transparency stack in cohort.

## Online presence consistency

### RISEGUIDE

Watch · 6

▲ +1.0

**Cross-channel consistency improved — official properties align on the same support contacts, and owned subdomains dominate search.**

Official properties all align on the same support contacts. RiseGuide-owned domains dominate first-page Google results, demonstrating cross-channel consistency. Organic and community presence remains light relative to download volume.

### LIVEN

Healthy · 7

Consistent branding across web, app stores, and Trustpilot. Official Health Professional Board page reinforces brand identity. Corporate address publicly displayed.

### COURSIV

Watch · 6

Branding consistent across visible channels, but corporate and leadership data largely absent — undermines coherence at the trust layer. Organic search shows a concerning complaint-page share.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Wikipedia, Crunchbase, official About-us, press coverage, and store listings all reinforce the same brand and corporate identity. Search results contain the broadest unique-domain set in cohort.

## 3 IDEAS · NEXT WEEK

# Initiatives that would lift the score

**01 Publish an About-us page with founder bio**

**LIFTS:** LEADERSHIP TRANSPARENCY · 3.0 → ~5 · Single content page — one photo, four links. Ship by Friday.

Liven publicly names CEO Shahrooz Chowdhury + 15 PhD advisors — scores 7. Headway publicly names founder Anton Pavlovsky with press coverage — scores 8.

**How to ship**

- 1 Commission a clean headshot of Oleksandr Matsiuk + draft a 2-paragraph bio (background + why RiseGuide exists)
- 2 Publish at [riseguide.com/about](https://riseguide.com/about) with photo, bio, and a LinkedIn link
- 3 Link the page from the homepage footer and the App Store / Google Play developer pages

**02 Publish an explicit refund + cancellation policy**

**LIFTS:** REFUND POLICY 3.0 → 4+ · EASE OF CANCELLATION 4.3 → 5+ · Policy page + reply templates — text only, no engineering. Ship by Wednesday.

Headway's published 24-hour pre-renewal rule anchors their 6.0 score on cancellation (best in cohort). Coursiv's public Money-Back Guarantee anchors their 4.0 on refund policy.

**How to ship**

- 1 Write a 1-page policy: **7-day no-questions refund + 24-hour pre-renewal cancel rule**
- 2 Publish at [riseguide.com/refunds](https://riseguide.com/refunds), link from the footer and every billing email
- 3 Update support reply templates + cross-link from in-app billing + store descriptions

**03 Publish a 'How your subscription works' explainer**

**LIFTS:** HIDDEN CHARGES 2.0 → 3+ · PRICE DISCLOSURE 5.0 → 6+ · Support article + email-template update. Text-only, no engineering, no funnel impact. Ship by Wednesday.

Reviewers report surprise at the first payment amount, but the underlying model (introductory discount, then renewal at full price) is industry-standard. The complaint is about clarity of communication, not the pricing itself.

**How to ship**

- 1 Write a plain-English article: **introductory price + when full price kicks in + how to cancel**
- 2 Publish at [support.riseguide.com/how-pricing-works](https://support.riseguide.com/how-pricing-works), link from every billing email + App Store description
- 3 Update support reply templates to cite the article URL on every billing-surprise thread